

THE MEN WHO CAN RESCUE INDIAN CRICKET

The Ford fiasco has proved that those running Indian cricket are no good at the job. But there are others of greater merit who deserve positions of authority within the next five years. You don't have to look very far for these good men.

■ **By Sharda Ugra**

If there ever was a confirmation required that Indian cricket needed immediate rescue, then the incident now enshrined as the Ford Fiasco has provided it. Even if Graham Ford went back after giving his word, the current Board has so little credibility that no one imagines them as the victims of improper conduct.

But the stumbling, bumbling Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) cannot be wished away, it cannot be sacked. It governs Indian cricket, yes, that too very badly, but maybe it should be freed from running the game. The necessary evil that is the cricket Board needs to be worked around. Leave the elections to the politicians who flock to the game. Build around them a steel frame of men whose commitment is foremost to cricket, not the accumulation of votes or propagation of their legend.

Men with vision and ambition, knowledge and humility, free of agendas, without the boulder-on-the-shoulder syndrome found in some ex-players. Finding such men may seem an impossible task. An India player mumbled,

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